



A blank canvas

On April 15, 1452, a baby boy was born in the Italian village of Anchiano. The exact time, his grandfather noted, was 10:30 in the evening.

The baby didn't know the village name, of course, or that Anchiano was a day's ride from the much bigger city of Florence. For that matter, he didn't know that Florence was in Italy, either.

In fact, Italy wasn't even a country in 1452. It was a collection of independent city-states. Places such as Florence, Venice, and Milan each had their own governments and ways of doing things. Sometimes they were friendly with each other, but not always.

The house in Anchiano
where Leonardo
was born

